

SOCIAL MEDIA BENCHMARK · SAUDI ARABIA · YOUTUBE

Reach is easy. Attention is earned.

How nine car brands really performed on YouTube, Oct 2025 – Sep 2026

9

OFFICIAL SAUDI BRAND CHANNELS

845

VIDEOS ANALYSED

640

COMMENTS CODED BY HAND

Views show who was reached. Engagement shows who cared.

Which Saudi car brands actually win attention on YouTube, and what earns it?

This analysis looks past view counts to what audiences actually did (liking, commenting, asking questions) over 12 months of public data.

- 01 · COLLECT

845 videos and 640 top-level comments via the official YouTube API
- 02 · MEASURE

Likes per 1,000 views as the engagement signal, alongside reach
- 03 · READ

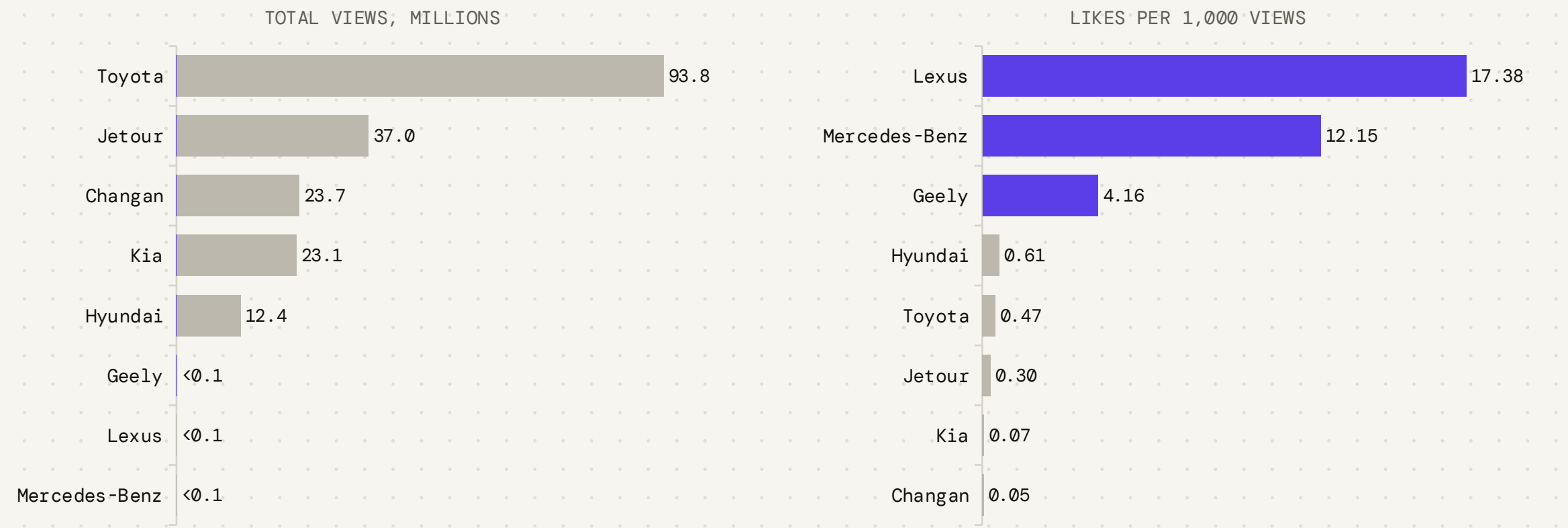
Every comment read and coded by hand into 8 themes

BRAND	SUBSCRIBERS	VIDEOS, 12 MO
ESTABLISHED BRANDS		
Toyota	179,000	243
Kia	8,780	190
Hyundai	7,610	181
Lexus	44,700	22
Mercedes-Benz	9,060	5
BMW	2,550	0
CHINESE CHALLENGERS		
Jetour	3,810	101
Geely	5,010	70
Changan	6,320	33

Six things the data says

- | | | |
|----|--|--|
| 01 | Reach and engagement rank the brands in opposite order. | The three biggest channels by views all rank in the bottom half on likes per 1,000 views. |
| 02 | Output swung between quarters; engagement didn't. | Hyundai tripled its output in Q2 and Jetour surged in Q3, but every big brand stayed under 1.5 likes per 1,000 views in every quarter. |
| 03 | Paid promotion drives most views, not engagement. | A small share of likely promoted videos accounts for most views, but draws few likes. |
| 04 | A branded series is the exception. | Toyota's adventure series was the only format that paired large reach with real engagement. |
| 05 | Influencer and sponsorship content can backfire or miss. | Jetour's talk show drew heavy cultural backlash; Changan's World Cup video got no comments about the car. |
| 06 | Comments are a sales pipeline, and premium brands are absent. | Price and availability questions sit in the comments, while BMW and Mercedes-Benz barely post. |

Reach and engagement rank the brands in opposite order

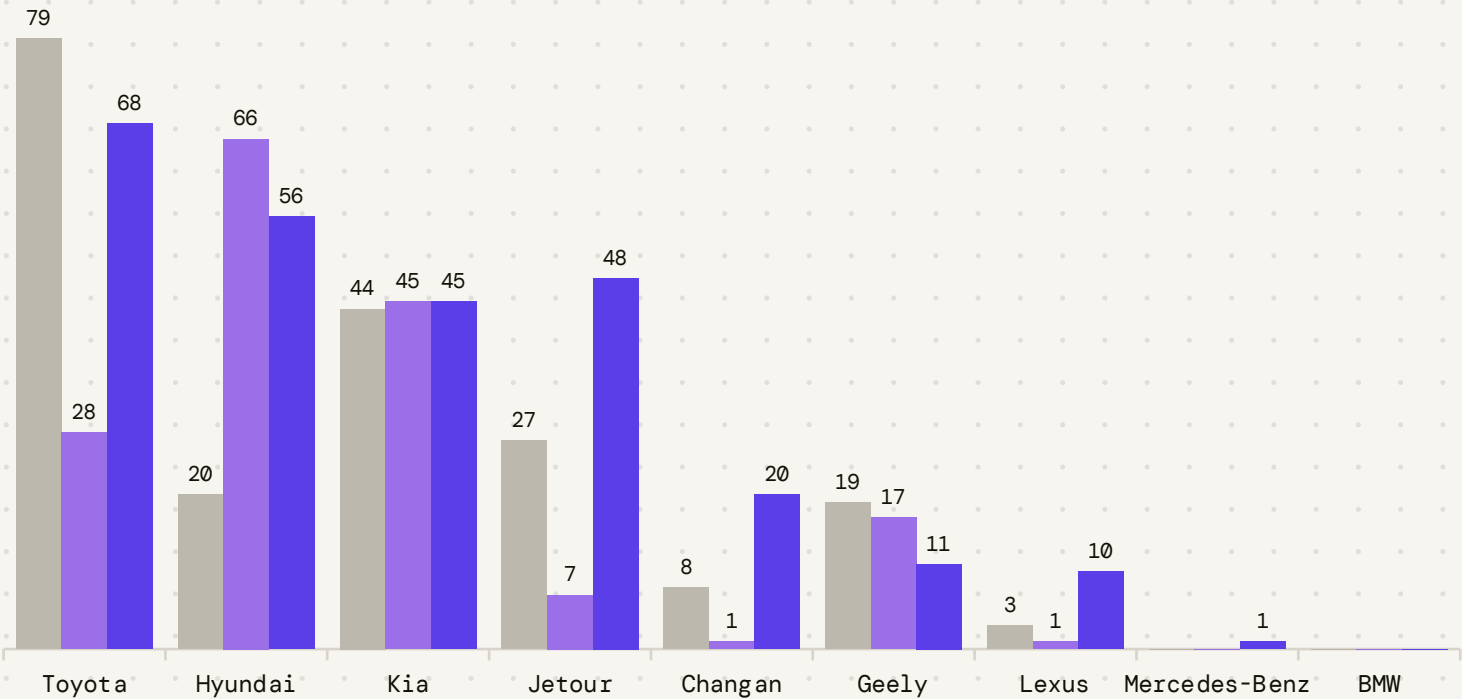


Highlighted: the three brands with the highest engagement rate. They are the three smallest channels by reach. BMW posted no videos in the period.

Hyundai tripled its output in Q2, and Jetour surged in Q3

VIDEOS POSTED PER QUARTER, 2026

■ Q1 2026 ■ Q2 2026 ■ Q3 2026



Across all brands: 200 videos in Q1, 165 in Q2, 259 in Q3. Q3 runs to 24 Sep.

Source: YouTube Data API v3 · public data from 9 official Saudi brand channels · 1 Oct 2025 - 24 Sep 2026

20 → 66

HYUNDAI'S VIDEOS, Q1 TO Q2, HELD AT 56 IN Q3

7 → 48

JETOUR'S VIDEOS, Q2 TO Q3

~45

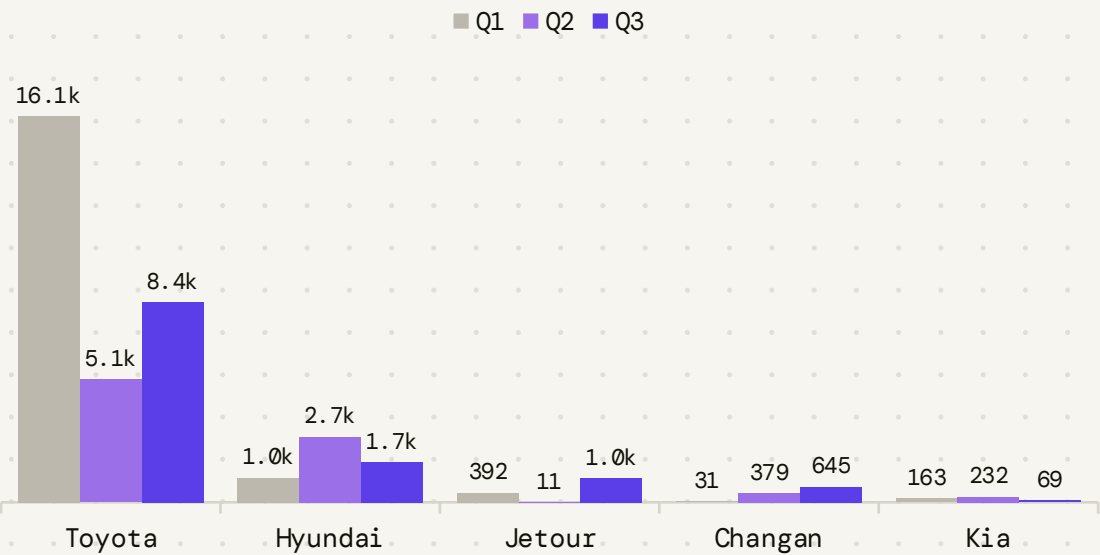
KIA EVERY QUARTER: THE MOST CONSISTENT POSTER

1

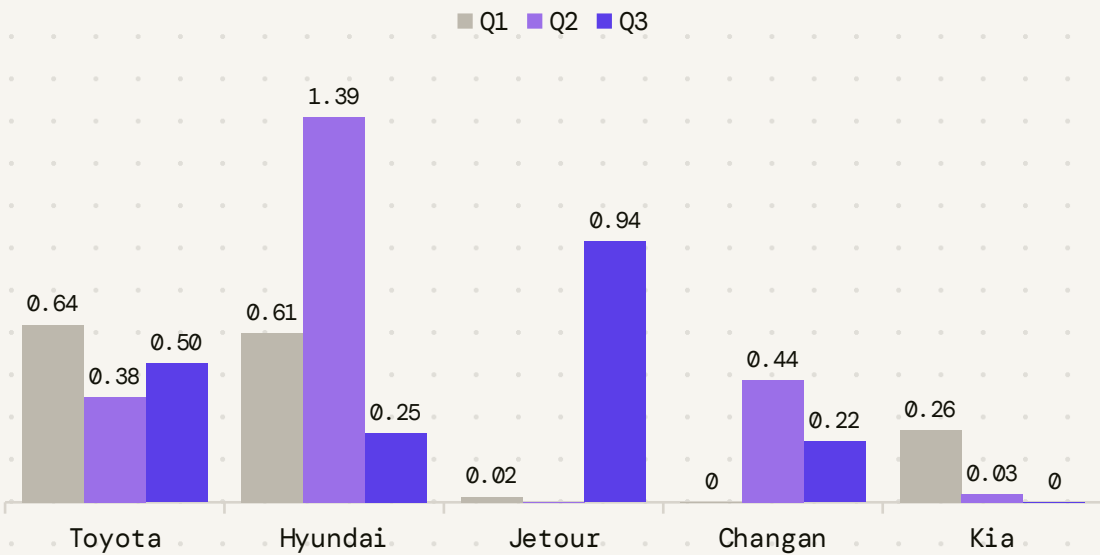
VIDEO FROM MERCEDES-BENZ AND BMW COMBINED IN 2026

Output swung; engagement barely moved

TOTAL LIKES ON VIDEOS POSTED EACH QUARTER



LIKES PER 1,000 VIEWS (SAME MEASURE AS SLIDE 4)



Hyundai peaked in Q2

Its busiest quarter was also its best: 2,730 likes and 1.39 per 1,000 views. Q3 fell back to 0.25.

Changan is slowly building

Likes grew every quarter (31 → 379 → 645), from a small base.

Kia: views up, likes down

Views rose from 0.6M to 14.0M while likes fell (163 → 69). One Q3 ad was 96% of its views.

Brands with meaningful reach shown. Jetour Q2 (7 videos, 1k views) not shown on the rate chart. Small channels keep higher rates on tiny audiences (Lexus 15–30, Geely 3.6–5.8), as on slide 4. Q3 runs to 24 Sep.

Paid promotion drives most views, but not engagement

13%

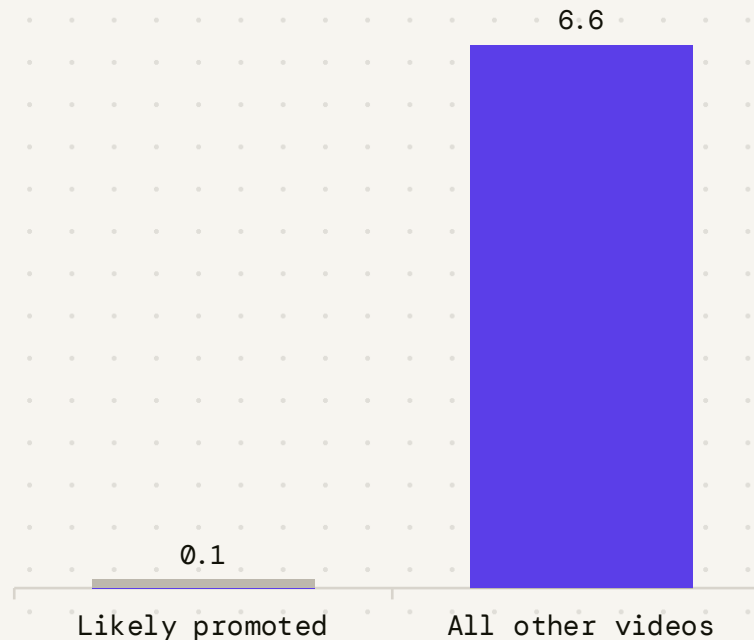
OF VIDEOS WERE LIKELY PROMOTED

79%

OF ALL VIEWS CAME FROM THOSE VIDEOS

Likely promoted: views more than 5× the channel's subscribers, and fewer than 1 like per 1,000 views.

MEDIAN LIKES PER 1,000 VIEWS



WHY IT MATTERS

Paid promotion is a normal part of a launch. But when most of a channel's views are paid, view counts stop telling you whether the content landed.

Likes and comments per 1,000 views separate what people chose to engage with from what they were simply shown.

Toyota's adventure series is the only format that pairs reach with real engagement

PROMOTED ONE-OFFS

31 videos

1.7M **0.03**

TYPICAL VIEWS
PER VIDEO

LIKES PER 1,000
VIEWS

Huge reach, few likes.

BRANDED SERIES

48 episodes

438k **1.4**

TYPICAL VIEWS
PER VIDEO

LIKES PER 1,000
VIEWS

“The desert is our witness”: reach at scale, and people still like it. 37% of all Toyota's likes.

EVERYDAY UPLOADS

164 videos

1.0k **12.4**

TYPICAL VIEWS
PER VIDEO

LIKES PER 1,000
VIEWS

Loyal fans engage, but barely anyone sees it.

Toyota only. “Typical” = median. Series: 48 episodes, 19.4M total views, 16,209 likes.

Jetour's influencer talk show drew the most conversation, and the most backlash

214

COMMENTS ON ONE EPISODE, THE MOST OF ANY VIDEO IN THE DATASET

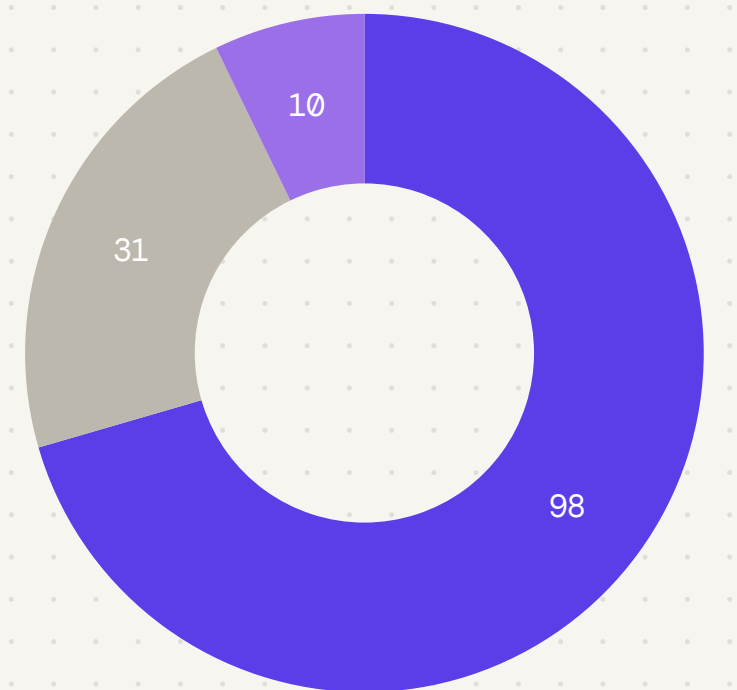
Jetour sponsored “Better with Kariman” (أحلى مع كريمان), a talk show filmed inside its cars. On the most-discussed episode, 98 of 139 top-level comments ignored the car: they objected, on cultural and religious grounds, to an unrelated man and woman chatting closely in it.

11 episodes · 7.3M views

ما الفائدة من هذا المحتوى 🤔

“What's the point of this content?”

ITS 139 TOP-LEVEL COMMENTS, CODED BY HAND



■ Criticism of the content ■ Other / off-topic ■ Praise

Changan's World Cup video won attention for the team, not the car

869k

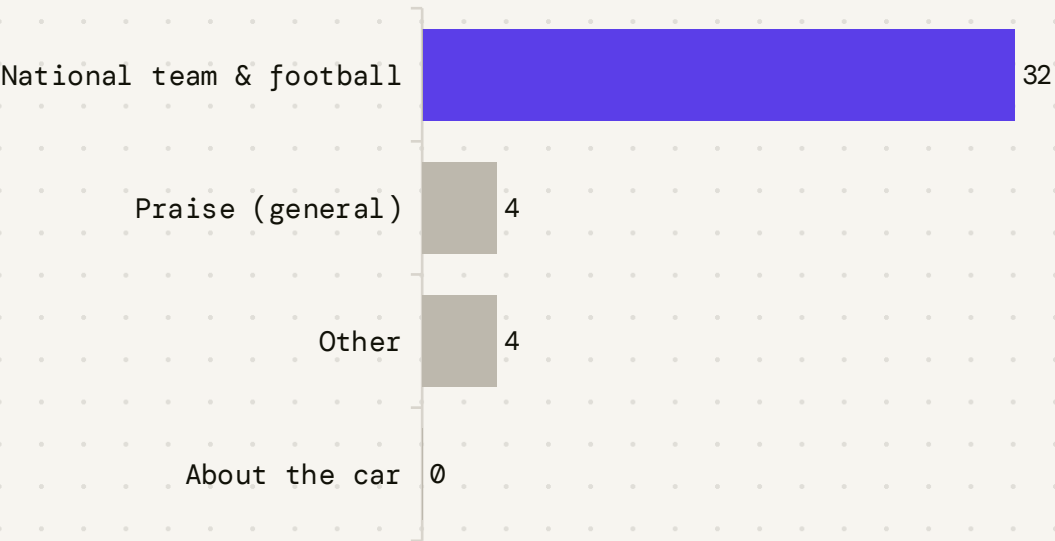
VIEWS ON CHANGAN'S TRIBUTE TO THE SAUDI NATIONAL TEAM

0 of 40

TOP-LEVEL COMMENTS MENTIONED THE CAR

Viewers used the comments to cheer, and then vent about, the team. The sponsorship put Changan in the national conversation, but nothing in the video tied that attention back to the brand.

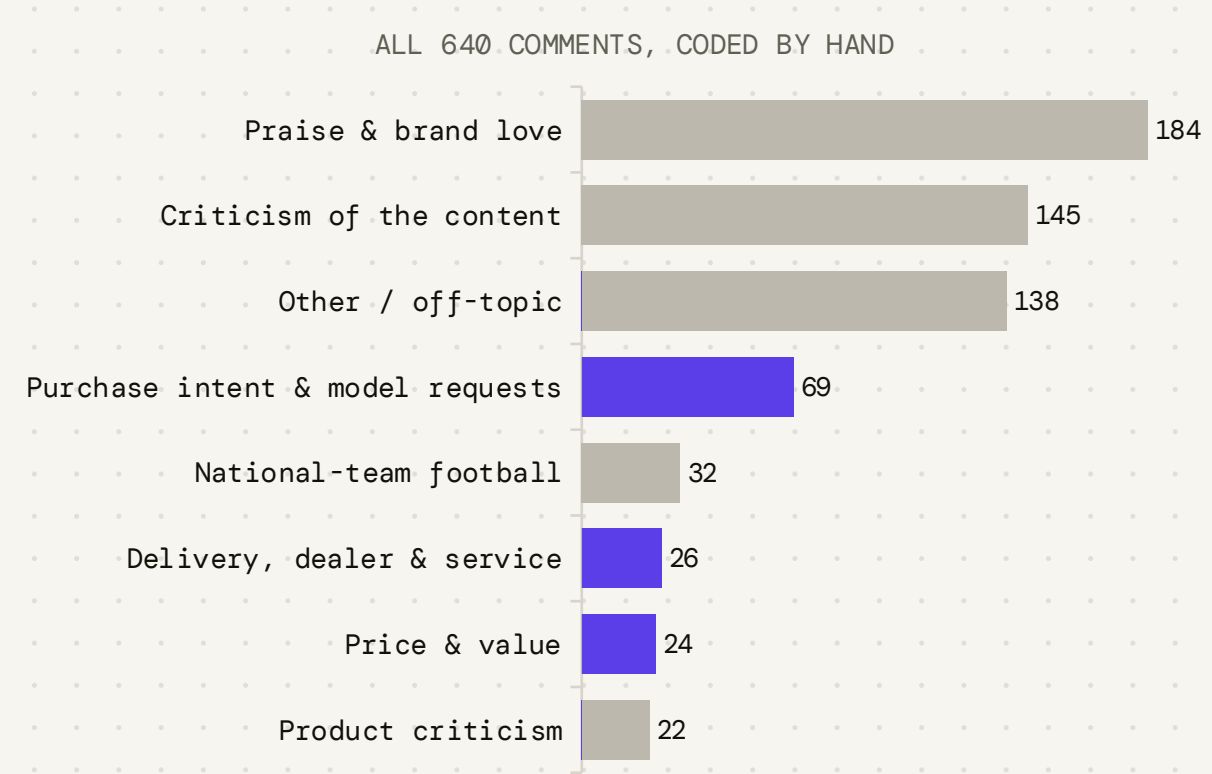
THE VIDEO'S 40 TOP-LEVEL COMMENTS, BY TOPIC



الله خيبت املنا بالاخضر للأسف

“Sadly, the Greens let us down.” (a typical comment)

The comment section is a sales pipeline hiding in plain sight



Highlighted: 119 comments (19%) are direct sales signals: questions about price, availability and delivery.

WHAT TOYOTA'S VIEWERS ARE ASKING

متى تتوفر في السوق؟

"When will it be available?"

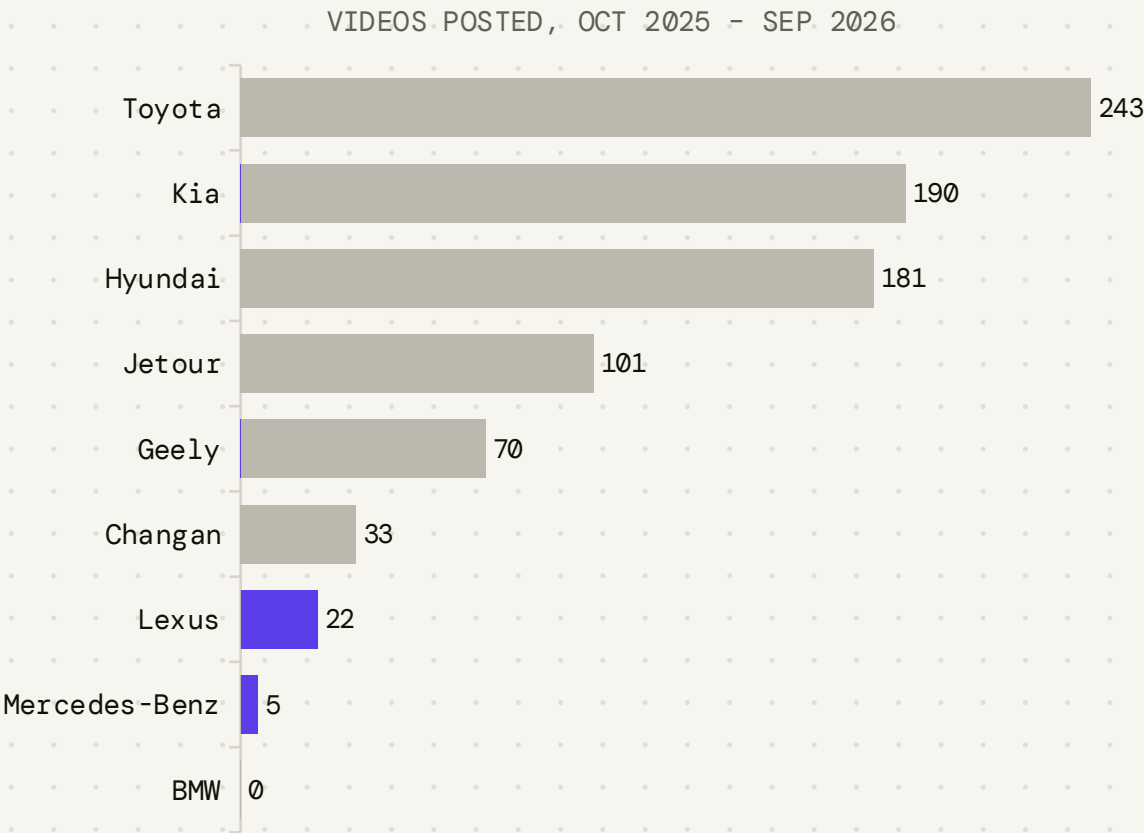
كم السعر

"How much is it?"

حاجزه راف لي قرابة ثلاثة اشهر اونلاين ولحد الان مافي ولا خبر

"I reserved a RAV4 online nearly three months ago and still have no news."

The premium German brands are missing from the conversation



0

BMW VIDEOS IN 12 MONTHS

5

MERCEDES-BENZ VIDEOS IN 12 MONTHS

PROOF THE AUDIENCE IS THERE

Lexus posted only 22 videos, yet earned the highest engagement of any brand: 17.4 likes per 1,000 views. Luxury buyers are watching; the German brands simply aren't showing up.

Five moves for car brands on YouTube in Saudi Arabia

01

Report engagement, not views

Track likes and comments per 1,000 views alongside reach, so paid and organic content can be compared fairly.

02

Back a series, not one-off spots

Put paid budget behind recurring, story-led content. It's the only format here that kept engagement at scale.

03

Vet influencers for cultural fit

Pre-test concepts with the target audience before launch; the backlash risk is predictable.

04

Treat comments as leads

Answer price and availability questions quickly and route them to sales. They're buyers raising their hands.

05

Premium brands: show up

A modest, consistent series could own a space Lexus proves is engaged and the German brands have left empty.

How this was done, and what it can't tell you

METHOD

- Public data only, collected with the official YouTube Data API v3 from each brand's official Saudi channel.
- Window: 1 Oct 2025 – 24 Sep 2026. 845 videos; 640 top-level comments (up to 200 per video).
- Engagement rate = likes per 1,000 views, calculated the same way on every slide: $\text{total likes} \div \text{total views}$.
- Every comment was read and coded by hand into 8 themes; no usernames were collected.

LIMITS

- Ad spend isn't public: “likely promoted” is inferred from views far above subscribers plus very low likes.
- YouTube only; brands may invest more on Instagram, TikTok or X.
- Small channels (Mercedes-Benz: 5 videos) give less stable rates.
- Hyundai has more than one Saudi distributor; only the main distributor's channel was used.